3.5.4 Screen Printing

In this printing method, fabric is spread on large table and design screen is placed on the fabric. The screen consists of wooden frame covered with nylon or silk cloth and the technique is called as silk screen printing. Lacquer is applied on the screen to make the areas except design opaque so that printing paste is transferred through the design only. Based on the number of colours, many numbers of screens are prepared to complete the design. The printed portion should be allowed to dry before placing the second screen. When screens are placed properly, they will produce a complete design.



Figure 3.12 Printing Paste

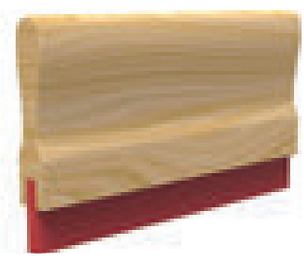


Figure 3.13 Squeegee

Advantages

- Whole width of fabric is printed at once and so the process is faster than block printing
- Screens can be preserved for future use

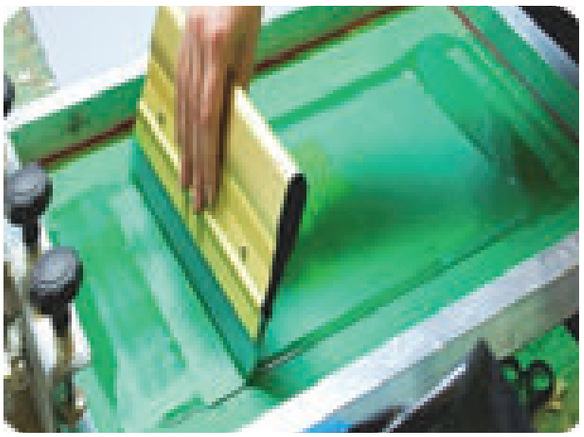


Figure 3.14 Printing the Fabric

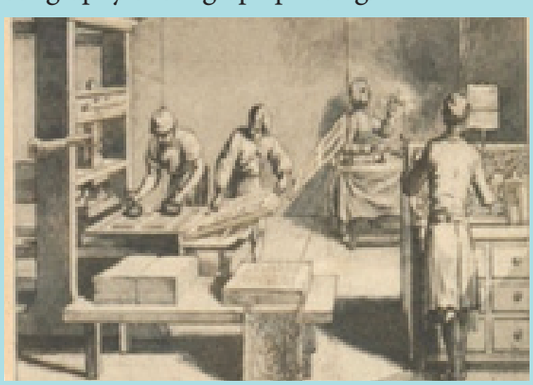


Figure 3.15 Screen Printed Fabric



When was First screen printing carried out?

It was first seen in China during Sung Dynasty (960–1279 AD (CE)). Further was adapted by other Asian countries like Japan, Western Europe, Asia until 18th century. The traditional process was called screen printing or silkscreen printing because silk was used in the process and the technique was referred as serigraphy or serigraph printing.



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